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Reddit lost 1M+ search visits a week.

And its CEO is pointing at Google's AI Mode.



Sources: Reddit Q3 2026 letter to shareholders (SEC Exhibit 99.2), p. 4 · Search Engine Journal, Oct 30, 2026 (Q3 earnings call)
Photo: Steve Jurvetson, CC BY 2.0, cut out, black and white

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It's in Reddit's own shareholder letter.

Our search referral traffic was down meaningfully in Q3, with the decline accelerating later in the quarter. The biggest impact was on logged-out and web traffic, but some of the impact flows through to logged-in and App traffic, since search referral is a common source of reengagement for users. The company helped to offset the declines by both driving reach primarily through user marketing and also by continuing to improve the product. These declines have continued into the early part of Q4. During October, we have seen that search traffic has dropped by more than 1 million referrals on average per week. If this rate of decline continues, current trends would suggest that total DAUqs could fall in Q4, by a low-double-digit percentage from our current base of 130 million DAUqs.

Q3 2026, page 4. Hardest hit: logged-out web traffic.

Source: Reddit Q3 2026 letter to shareholders (SEC Exhibit 99.2), p. 4

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On the earnings call:

AI Mode “does not drive traffic.”



Source: Search Engine Journal, Oct 30, 2026 (Q3 earnings call)
Photo: Steve Jurvetson, CC BY 2.0, cut out, black and white

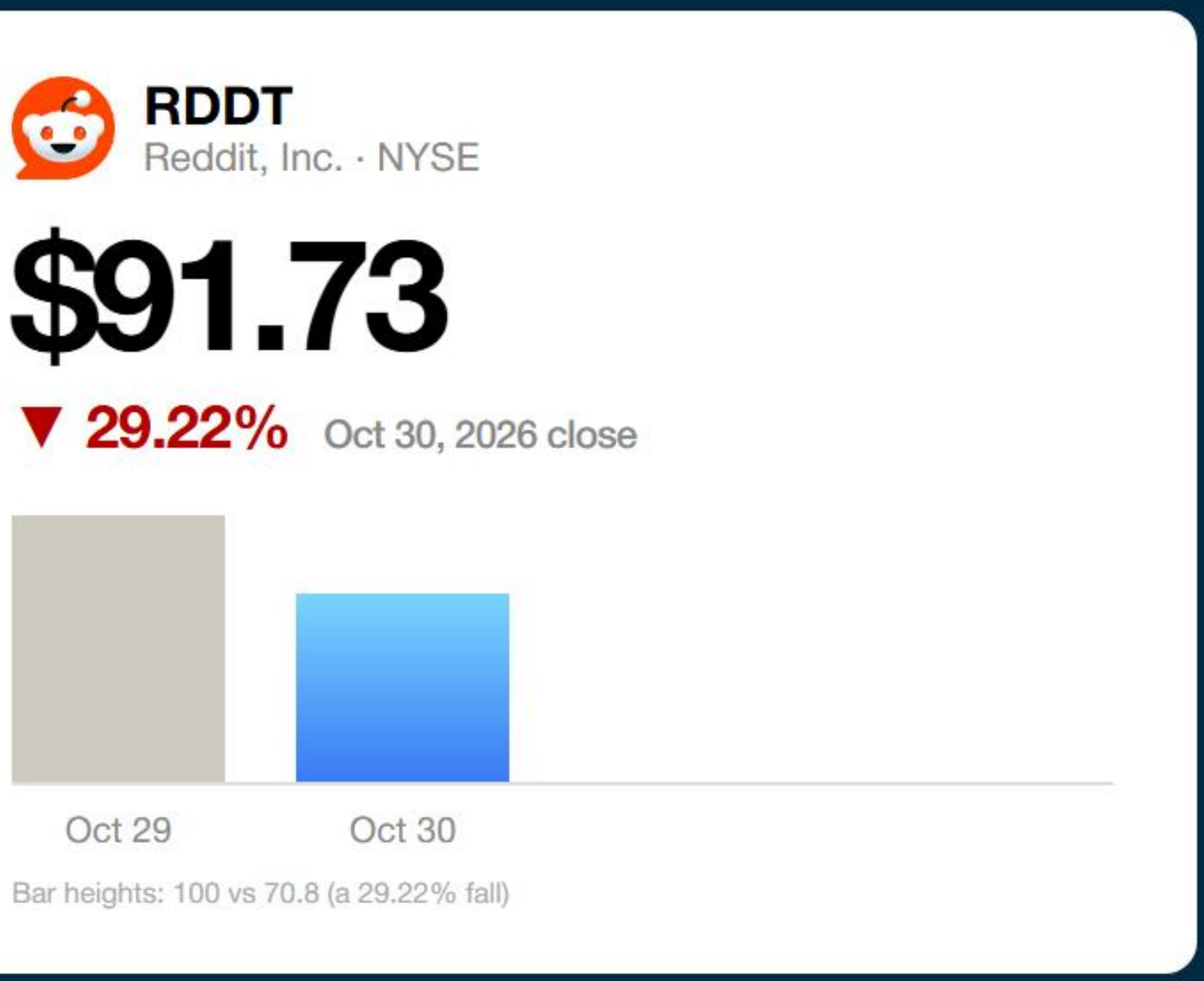
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The next day:

Reddit's shares fell 29%.

Its biggest one-day drop ever.



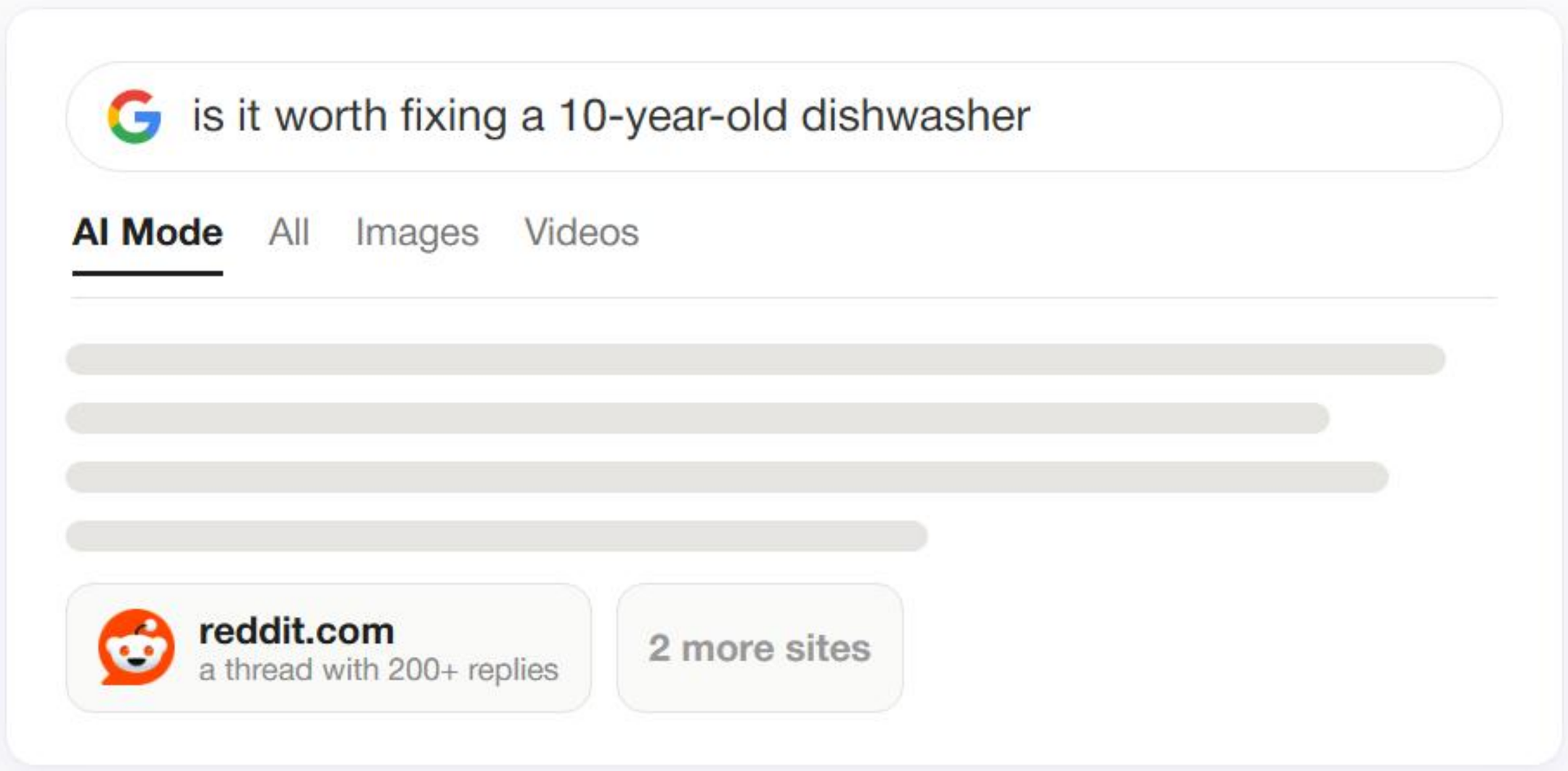
Source: The Globe and Mail, Oct 30, 2026

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But Google still crawls Reddit "as hard as ever."

The answers use the threads. **The clicks don't come.**



Quote: Search Engine Journal, Oct 30, 2026 (Q3 earnings call) · Search page drawn by TMV to show the idea

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Stop counting clicks. Track the answer.

What an AI answer can give you

- ✓ Your brand named in the answer
- ✓ Your page cited as a source
- ✗ A visit to your site (not always)

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Do AI answers name your brand?

Comment **CHECK** and we'll send you our free AI visibility checker.

